

Department of Computer Science
Student Guidelines for
CS6520 Project /
CS6522 Project in Autonomous Driving /
CS6524 Project in Generative AI /
CS6526 Project in Trustworthy AI /
CS6529 Project in Artificial Intelligence

Important Information

Project (CS6520/CS6522/CS6524/CS6526/CS6529) is a two-semester project-based course, which is a bit different from other taught courses. Here are some important points:

1. You need to find a supervisor, based on your own research interest. It is suggested that your proposed supervisor is not concurrently handling more than 6 graduate Guided Study or Project students.
2. Extensive implementation and experiments are expected for this course (unlike CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537 Guided Study). While your topic for Project is expected to be the same as that of CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537 (if taken in the previous semester), it is possible to have different topics (or even different supervisors) as the two courses are independent. Clearly it will be more advantageous, though, to have the same supervisor and topic.
3. For students who have taken CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537 previously, in order to avoid double counting, although the work you have done for CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537 can be included in final submission for Project for the sake of completeness, they will not be counted when your work in Project is assessed. Since the background study and initial proposal are already done in CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537, it is expected that the work for Project will contain substantially more testing, experiments, comparisons, and analysis.
4. If you are concurrently taking CS6534/CS6535/CS6536/CS6537 and Project in the *same* semester, it is suggested that you choose different topics for each course.
5. If you are unable to find a supervisor by the deadline, please contact Professor HOU Junhui (jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk) as soon as possible to get assistance in the process.
6. Academic dishonesty is regarded as a serious offence in the University. Any related offence can lead to disciplinary action with a penalty including expulsion from the University and debarment from re-admission. Please note that submitting work that is not yours without duly acknowledging the source is considered plagiarism. To prevent plagiarism, you should express ideas with your own words. The file size is limited to 10 MB, please remove image captures and save as reduced size PDF format for Turnitin submission.

Our Canvas System is now equipped with tools for checking plagiarism, please remember to check for plagiarism via Turnitin Assignment before submission of the report.

<https://help.turnitin.com/feedback-studio/turnitin-website/student/submitting-a-paper/file-upload-submission.htm>

If you are still in doubt, please consult your supervisor firstly.

For Academic Honesty, please visit our website:

[CityU Student Guide on Academic Honesty](#)

7. **For writing assignments and reports, students are allowed to use GenAI, but its use must be acknowledged through proper citation and referencing.** In this case, GenAI is considered as a secondary source (an interpretation and analysis of primary sources) or even a tertiary source (an encyclopedia). Copying text or ideas produced by GenAI *without acknowledgment* is considered plagiarism. However, please be careful as GenAI can hallucinate (confabulate) false information without knowing it. Thus, students should try to find other sources to corroborate any information provided by GenAI. Similarly, if GenAI is used for copy-editing of the report in any way this must be clearly stated, e.g. The report was copy-edited by ChatGPT to fix grammatical errors and improve readability. The ideas presented in this report and originally from the author, and no additional content/ideas have been added by ChatGPT.

Schedule

The schedule for the assessment tasks are given in the below table.

	Semester B 2025/26 & Summer Term 2026
Topic Selection	Semester B, Week 1, Tuesday 13 January 2026
Project Proposal	Semester B, Week 3, Tuesday 27 January 2026
1st Interim Report	Semester B, Week 12, Wednesday 8 April 2026
2nd Interim Report	Summer Term, Week 1, Tuesday 9 June 2026
Final Report	Summer Term, Week 7, Tuesday 21 July 2026
Presentation	Student Revision Week 27-31 July 2026

**Download Academic Calendar http://www6.cityu.edu.hk/arro/ac_calendar.asp*

Assessment and Requirements

The course has continuous assessment throughout the semester. The following are the assessment tasks and requirements.

1. Project Topic Selection [0% marks]

Select a topic for your project, and find an appropriate supervisor. The areas of specialism of our faculty members can be found at:

<https://www.cs.cityu.edu.hk/people/academic-staff>

The following information must be emailed to Professor HOU Junhui (jh.hou@cityu.edu.hk) and cc to Jamie Au (jamieau@cityu.edu.hk):

Title of project, student information (name, student no. and telephone no.) and name of supervisor.

2. Project Proposal [5% marks]

A one-page proposal consisting of clear specifications of the scope and objectives of the project. The proposal should contain an introduction to the problem, and why it is important. The proposal should also include the deliverables of the project (e.g., application software, performance analysis, theoretical results, experiment results).

Submit a soft copy to course page on [Canvas](#) and **download the Similarity Report**. The one-page proposal, together with the similarity report should be uploaded to the [Assessments Submission System of the Department of Computer Science](#).

3. Project Management [5% marks]

Overall project management including developing and maintaining the study schedule.

4. 1st Interim Report [5% marks]

The 1st Interim Report should discuss your current progress on the study, and should consist of **15 pages**. Here are the requirements:

- (1) Introduction – Clearly describe background of the selected topic and the objectives and why the topic is useful and potential outcome (prototype of application software, performance analysis or theoretical results, etc.).
- (2) Related work – Illustrate the problem as associated with existing and related systems/solutions. Description of advantages and disadvantages between existing solutions. Discussion of the relationship between the existing solutions and the proposed solution.
- (3) System modeling and structure – the proposed solution. Discussion of the justifications of the design choices, and how they address existing limitations.
- (4) The methodology and algorithms you will design/implement for the proposed solution.
- (5) Preliminary performance analysis or experiments of your algorithm/system.
- (6) Milestones and overall schedule for your project.
- (7) Work to be completed for the next report.
- (8) References.

Also note the following requirements:

- Submit a soft copy to course page on [Canvas](#) and **download the Similarity Report**. The 1st Interim report, together with the similarity report should be uploaded to the [Assessments Submission System of the Department of Computer Science](#).
- All figures and table that are taken from other sources need to be cited, e.g., with the following text “(figure from [1])”.

For case of similarity rate higher than 25%, it may lead to severe penalties.

5. 2nd Interim Report [5% marks]

The 2nd interim report should be an expanded version of the 1st Interim Report, consisting of **20-30 pages**. Sections (4) (5), and (6) should be expanded with more information, and Section (7) should be updated.

Also note the following requirements:

- Submit a soft copy to course page on [Canvas](#) and **download the Similarity Report**. The 2nd Interim report, together with the similarity report should be uploaded to the [Assessments Submission System of the Department of Computer Science](#).
- All figures and table that are taken from other sources need to be cited, e.g., with the following text “(figure from [1])”.

The maximum allowable overlap between the two interim reports is 50%. **The 2nd interim report should include 50% of new content**. If the similarity rate exceeds this threshold, it may result in severe penalties.

6. Final Report [20% marks for the report, 46% marks for technical merit]

The final report should include all the outcomes of your project. It will be assessed on both the technical merit (46% marks) of the report, as well as the quality of the report (20%). The final report should be ~30-40 pages (excluding programs).

The maximum allowable overlap between the two interim reports and the final report is 50%. **The final report should include 50% of new content**. If the similarity rate exceeds this threshold, it may result in severe penalties.

Here are the requirements:

- (1) Introduction (see description for Interim Reports).
- (2) Related work (see description for Interim Reports).
- (3) System modeling and structure (see description for Interim Reports).
- (4) The methodology and algorithms used in the design/implementation of the system. (see description for Interim Reports).
- (5) Performance analysis or experiments of your algorithm/system – Evaluations comparing to existing works, and results supporting the design choices versus alternative choices.
- (6) Conclusion – A concise summary of the project.
- (7) Future Work – Discussion of possible future directions of work.
- (8) References

Also note the following requirements:

- Submit a soft copy to course page on [Canvas](#) and **download the Similarity Report**. The final report, together with the similarity report should be uploaded to the [Assessments Submission System of the Department of Computer Science](#).
- Submit source code and project files to [Canvas](#).
- All figures and tables that are taken from other sources need to be cited, e.g., with the following text “(figure from [1])”.

7. Presentation [14% marks]

The oral presentation should be ‘live’. You should present in person or on Zoom for about 15 minutes, followed by an additional 3–5 minutes for questions from your Supervisor and 2nd Reader. If it is difficult to schedule a presentation time with everyone you can present twice – to the Supervisor and 2nd Reader separately.

8. Report Format

Cover Page: Student name, student number, project title and supervisor name should be written on a cover page of each report.

Margins (top/bottom/left/right): 2.54 cm

Font Name: Times New Roman (font size: 12)

Line Spacing: Single Line

Late Penalty:

For an assessment task that is turned in late, a penalty of 20% of its maximum mark will be applied for each day late.

Grading Remarks:

As Project is a two-semester research-related course, it is expected that there should be a thorough literature review, analysis of current systems, a proposed system or proposed methodology, substantial testing and experiments, and analysis. *Only projects that are complete enough to be submitted to conference or journals will be considered for A or A+ grades.*

Contact Information

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